Day 79 (stop 2 of 3) - Otter Lake, Bard

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 101 · Cape Chin

4.1 km / 2.5 mi	~1.5 h	2.6 km new	231 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

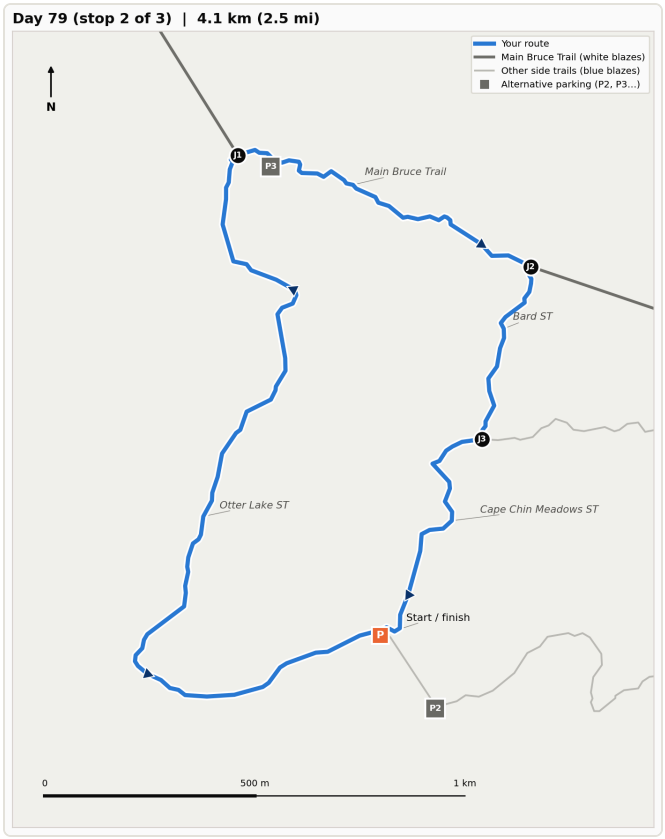
Park (P): Roadside parking along the shoulders of Cape Chin North Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day79b_hike101.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Otter Lake Side Trail (2.2 km); Bard Side Trail (0.5 km)

Same day: this is stop 2 of 3 on day 79 (7.8 mi of hiking, about 483 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 100, 2.1 mi from Parking at the south end of Carter Rd. Access to the Trail is via a short side trail…; stop 3: hike 102, 3.1 mi from On roadside at the south end of Harkins Rd.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on the shoulders of Cape Chin North Rd. Pull fully off the road.
- **Otter Lake Side Trail:** A 2.2 km blue-blazed trail. No specific description was found.
- **Main Bruce Trail & Bard Side Trail:** Around Cape Chin the main trail passes a beaver pond and crosses several old pastures. The short Bard Side Trail (about 0.5 km) is a cut-across between the trails near Cape Chin.
- **Cape Chin Meadows Side Trail:** Winds through old farm fields, bush lots and back roads. A club group hiking here saw signs of black bears, so keep Zappy leashed and close.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking along the eastern shoulder of Cape Chin North Rd where the side trail enters map	Free	0.0	220 m	Otter Lake
P3	Normally a school bus turn-around, cars may park here on weekends and during summer map	Free	2.2	110 m	Otter Lake

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking along the shoulders of Cape Chin North Rd. Head west on the blue-blazed Otter Lake Side Trail.
2.1	1.3	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) There is trailhead parking here (Normally a school bus turn-around, cars may park here on weekends and during

		summer).
3.0	1.8	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Bard Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.4	2.1	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Cape Chin Meadows Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Cape Chin Meadows Side Trail goes off on your left.)
4.1	2.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, a Vanderplas family trip report and Bruce Peninsula Press.